

# RTAM FOUNDATION — BRAND BOOK

ऋतम् फाउंडेशन • RTAM Foundation

## I • PHILOSOPHY

**R̥tam** (ऋतम्) names the cosmic order that holds — the structuring principle that turns chaos into form, season into return, breath into measure. It is the oldest word the Vedic tradition has for *truth* in the sense of *the way things are*. The foundation takes its name from that word, and its identity from a single mark: a dot beneath the letter R.

The dot is the *bindu* — root, seed, source, the point from which form arises. In the wordmark it sits beneath the R as the diacritic of *r̥*. It is the brand signature. Without it the wordmark reads "RTAM"; with it the wordmark reads "R̥TAM" — and the foundation's whole claim is in that subtraction and return.

The visual system that follows is built to keep that mark intentional at every scale.

## 2 · NAMES

| FORM                          | USE                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ṚTAM Foundation</b>        | Primary written form in Latin-script contexts. Always with the dot under R when typeset; <b>RTAM Foundation</b> is the public ASCII fallback. |
| ऋतम् फाउंडेशन                 | Common-register Devanagari. Use in bilingual lockups, Hindi-speaking audiences, signage.                                                      |
| ऋतम् प्रतिष्ठान               | Pure-Sanskritic Devanagari ( <i>pratiṣṭhāna</i> — "established institution"). For scholarly, sacred, or trust-deed contexts.                  |
| <b>Rtambhareshvara Mandir</b> | The temple. Plain-English Latin form for physical signage and donor materials.                                                                |
| <b>Ṛtambhareśvara Mandir</b>  | The temple, pronunciation form (mixed diacritic: leading Ṛ = R + bindu, native ś̐ ). Scholarly / sacred register.                             |
| ऋतम्भरेश्वर मंदिर             | The temple, Devanagari. Always present in the temple lockup.                                                                                  |

**Spelling lock.** The canonical Latin spellings are exactly as written above — **RTAM** / **Rtambhareshvara** (and the all-caps **RTAMBHARESHVARA** in the temple lockup). Do not "correct" them to other IAST transliterations; the diacritic forms ( **Ṛ** , **ś̐** ) are an *additive* register, never a replacement.

## 3 · THE LOGO SYSTEM

The identity is a **two-entity × two-script tree** bound by one shared root mark.

- **Two entities:** **RTAM Foundation** (the organisation) and **Rtambhareshvara Mandir** (the temple).
- **Two scripts:** Latin and Devanagari.
- **One shared crest:** the vocalic-R — **Ṛ** (R + bindu) in Latin, **ऋ** in Devanagari — because *both names begin with it* (**ṚTAM**, **Ṛtambhareshvara**). The crest names the family; the wordmark names the entity.

Two layout rules fall out of the names: the **Foundation is set horizontally** (short acronym + smaller descriptor on one baseline); the **Temple is stacked** (its long name centred over the descriptor). Each entity keeps that structure across both scripts. **Latin forms carry the gold bindu under the leading R; Devanagari forms never do** — **ऋ** already *is* the vocalic-R, so

adding a dot would be redundant. The pieces share no other chrome; what they share is this crest and the typographic family.

### 3.1 PRIMARY WORDMARK

The wordmark is the foundation's voice in public. Six variants:

| FILE                                           | USE                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>rtam-wordmark-sacred-RTAM-dot.svg</code> | Canonical. Charcoal letters, gold bindu.                                                                                                                                                             |
| <code>rtam-wordmark-ivory-golddot.svg</code>   | The sacred form <b>on dark</b> : ivory letters, gold bindu preserved. Default on charcoal / indigo / photographic dark surfaces.                                                                     |
| <code>rtam-wordmark-gold.svg</code>            | All-gold. For sacred contexts, embossed printing, foil.                                                                                                                                              |
| <code>rtam-wordmark-charcoal.svg</code>        | All-charcoal. For single-color reproduction (mono printing, fax, microform).                                                                                                                         |
| <code>rtam-wordmark-ivory.svg</code>           | All-ivory on a <b>transparent</b> ground — for dark surfaces where a second colour (the gold bindu) cannot reproduce. Intentionally invisible on white; always preview on the intended dark surface. |
| <code>rtam-wordmark-public-RTAM.svg</code>     | ASCII-only, no bindu. <b>Use only</b> when the bindu cannot be reliably reproduced (low-resolution sign vinyl, embroidered shirts under 6 cm wide).                                                  |

The Foundation name also exists as a **standalone Devanagari wordmark** in both registers:

`rtam-wordmark-devanagari-pratishthan.svg` (ऋतम् प्रतिष्ठान, the Sanskritic default) and `rtam-wordmark-devanagari-faundeshan.svg` (ऋतम् फाउंडेशन, the common register). Both set ऋतम् large with the descriptor smaller on a shared baseline, mirroring the Latin wordmark; neither carries a bindu.

The bindu is **drawn as a separate <circle>** in every Latin SVG. It is not a Unicode combining mark. This is deliberate: the bindu must remain exact in size and position across every reproduction surface. Its geometry follows one rule — centred under the leading R's ink,  $cy = baseline + 0.233 \cdot fontsize$ ,  $r = fontsize \div 12$  — with exactly **two sanctioned deviations**: the **circle-enclosed icon** centres the bindu on the canvas axis (cx 128) so the composition sits still inside its ring, and the **favicon** enlarges the bindu ( $r$  2.86 at fs 26,  $\approx fs \div 9$ ) and tightens its gap so the dot survives a 16 px browser tab. No other asset may deviate.

### 3.1A TEMPLE WORDMARKS

The temple name is set in three standalone renderings, all stacked (name over descriptor):

| FILE                                             | USE                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>rtam-temple-wordmark-latin.svg</code>      | Rtambhareshvara / Temple. Plain English form (signage, donor materials). Leading R carries the bindu.                                                                       |
| <code>rtam-temple-wordmark-diacritic.svg</code>  | Ṛtambhareśvara / Mandir. The pronunciation form — leading R + bindu reads as Ṛ, the native Cinzel <code>š</code> carries the palatal sibilant. Scholarly / sacred register. |
| <code>rtam-temple-wordmark-devanagari.svg</code> | ऋतम्भरेश्वर / मंदिर. Devanagari, no bindu.                                                                                                                                  |

### 3.2 R-MONOGRAM

A square mark of the bare R with the bindu beneath, in two families:

- **Open form** — sacred (charcoal R + gold bindu, the default), all-gold, all-charcoal, all-ivory, and sacred-on-dark (ivory R + gold bindu) for plain-background contexts.
- **Circle-enclosed** — gold ring (charcoal R), all-charcoal, or all-gold (dark surfaces), for app icons, social avatars, and any context where the mark needs to claim its own visual territory.

Plus `favicon.svg` (32 viewBox, charcoal R) and `favicon-dark.svg` (ivory R) for light and dark browser tabs. The favicon scales cleanly to **64 px**; above that, switch to the full R-monogram SVG, because the bindu spacing was tuned for the favicon's small size and visibly detaches at 8× scale.

### 3.3 DEVANAGARI ऋ MONOGRAM

The Devanagari letter ऋ (Ṛ) is itself the bindu's complement — the glyph carries the sacred mark intrinsically. The ऋ monogram therefore has **no separate dot**. It is the only icon in the system without one, and that absence is the point.

Four variants: gold / black / ivory / circle-enclosed.

### 3.4 LOCKUPS

| FILE                                                         | USE                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>rtam-bilingual-foundation.svg</code>                   | Common-register: RTAM Foundation over ऋतम् फाउंडेशन. Default bilingual.                                                                      |
| <code>rtam-sanskritic-pratishthan.svg</code>                 | Pure-Sanskritic: RTAM Foundation over ऋतम् प्रतिष्ठान. Scholarly / sacred.                                                                   |
| <code>rtambhareshvara-mandir-lockup.svg</code>               | Temple name, both scripts, leading R carries the bindu. Wider viewBox (1280) to fit the longest name.                                        |
| <code>rtambhareshvara-mandir-lockup-ivory-golddot.svg</code> | The temple lockup on dark: ivory scripts, gold bindu + rule. Event banners, night signage.                                                   |
| <code>donation-lockup.svg</code>                             | Wordmark + thin gold rule + a single quiet supporting line (charcoal at light weight — quiet by weight, legible by colour). Header, not CTA. |

## 4 · COLOR

Seven tokens. Use them by name, not by hex. The CSS variables live in `brand/palette/colors.css`.

| TOKEN                         | HEX                  | ROLE                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>--rtam-gold</code>      | <code>#C8A15A</code> | Antique gold. The bindu. Rules and accents.                         |
| <code>--rtam-ivory</code>     | <code>#F7F3E9</code> | Warm ivory. The default ground.                                     |
| <code>--rtam-charcoal</code>  | <code>#1A1A1A</code> | Near-black. Body text and the wordmark on light grounds.            |
| <code>--rtam-sandstone</code> | <code>#E6DED1</code> | Soft warm gray. Borders, dividers, panel chrome.                    |
| <code>--rtam-indigo</code>    | <code>#1C1A3D</code> | Sacred-night indigo. Reserved for sacred / poster / cover surfaces. |
| <code>--rtam-bronze</code>    | <code>#9B6A2F</code> | Deeper gold. Use sparingly for emphasis on ivory.                   |
| <code>--rtam-stone</code>     | <code>#B8B1A4</code> | Quiet stone gray. Supporting copy that should not compete.          |

**The wordmark must work in single-colour charcoal.** This is a non-negotiable reproduction test — every variant of the wordmark has been verified in flat `#1A1A1A` (one ink, no gold) for fax, single-color print, and microform. ( `#1A1A1A` is charcoal, not `#000000` ; the earlier "pure black" wording overstated the hex. If a vendor's process demands literal K-100 black, the charcoal files may be reproduced at 100% K — the geometry is the test, not the 10% luminance difference.)

**File names vs. tokens (v2 rename applied, 2026-07-12):** file suffixes are now token-truthful — `-ivory` means ivory `#F7F3E9` , `-charcoal` means charcoal `#1A1A1A` , `-garbhagriha` means the bhasma-ash-on-mahakala register; `-golddot` still marks two-tone variants that preserve the gold bindu on an otherwise single-colour mark. (The historical `-white` / `-black` suffixes are gone from the tree.)

**Contrast (measured WCAG ratios).** Charcoal `#1A1A1A` on ivory is 15.7:1 — the body-text pairing, comfortably AAA. But two warm pairings fall **below** the 4.5:1 AA threshold and are **decorative / large-only**: gold `#C8A15A` on ivory is **2.18:1**, and stone `#B8B1A4` on ivory is **1.92:1**. Use gold for the bindu, rules, and large display accents — never for body copy or small UI text on ivory. For functional text on ivory, use charcoal; reserve stone for quiet captions that are large enough not to need to be read at a glance.

## 5 · TYPOGRAPHY

Four vendored families ( `brand/fonts/` ); three do the talking, one stands reserve.

| FACE                                      | USE                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cinzel</b> (400 / 500 / 600 / 700)     | Display Latin. The wordmark, headlines, certificate citations, the brand's voice in public.                                                         |
| <b>Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit</b> (regular) | The sacred face. All Devanagari typesetting. (Its built-in Latin glyphs are under evaluation as the brand's quote/body serif — not yet sanctioned.) |
| <b>Inter</b> (300 / 400 / 500 / 600)      | Working sans. Body copy, captions, metadata, anything functional.                                                                                   |
| <b>Marcellus</b> (400)                    | Reserve display serif — second name in the Cinzel fallback stack only. Never set deliberately.                                                      |

CDN-only fallbacks (never vendored, never load-bearing): Noto Serif / Sans Devanagari, after Tiro in the Devanagari stacks.

A printable font-installation note for vendors is in `brand/README.md`. Print shops without the fonts should use the **outlined masters in `brand/dist/outlined/`** — every glyph is already a `<path>`, no fonts required. (Inkscape `Path → Object to Path` on the live-text sources achieves the same.)

## 6 · SPACING & CLEAR-SPACE

The wordmark gets a clear-space margin equal to the **cap-height of R** on every side. Measured in real Cinzel, that cap-height is **≈84 viewBox units** in the canonical 1080×240 wordmark (not 120 — the earlier figure mistook the font-size for the cap-height). Nothing — image, fold, type, or border — may enter that zone.

The R-monogram (square icon) gets a clear-space margin equal to ¼ of its width. The Devanagari ऋ monogram uses the same rule.

Lockups inherit their wordmark's clear-space. The temple lockup additionally requires its full 1280-unit viewBox; do not crop or letter-space-reduce the temple name.

## 7 · DO & DON'T

### Do

- Place the wordmark on ivory, charcoal, or sacred-night indigo.
- Use the bindu in every reproduction where it is legible ( $\geq 6$  cm wide).
- Pair Cinzel with Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit; pair both with Inter for body.
- Keep the bindu on the Latin marks and off the Devanagari ones.

### Don't

- Don't move, resize, or recolor the bindu independently of the wordmark. Use a variant file instead.
- Don't substitute the Cinzel R with a different serif. The R's shape is part of the mark.
- Don't render the wordmark on a busy photographic background. Use the ivory, charcoal, or indigo ground.
- Don't outline, emboss, drop-shadow, or gradient the wordmark. The mark is flat. Always.
- Don't add a dot to the Devanagari ऋ marks. The glyph already carries the vocalic-R.
- Don't use the public RTAM (no-bindu) variant when the bindu would reproduce correctly. It exists only as a fallback.
- Don't set gold or stone as body text on ivory — both fall below AA contrast; they are decorative / large-only.

## 8 · APPLICATIONS

The brand kit ships HTML mockups for the most common contexts. See

`brand/previews/mockups/` (sources) and `brand/exports/mockups/` (rendered PNGs).



| MOCKUP                  | USE                                                              |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| website-header.html     | Web nav with wordmark + nav + Donate CTA.                        |
| letterhead.html         | Trust correspondence, formal letters.                            |
| donation-receipt.html   | Contribution receipts with 80G reference.                        |
| donation-poster.html    | Annual renovation drive poster (1080×1350, sacred-night indigo). |
| instagram-avatar.html   | Three avatar variants for social platforms.                      |
| youtube-banner.html     | 2560×1440 with explicit mobile-safe area.                        |
| certificate.html        | Certificate of Contribution with the bilingual lockup.           |
| favicon-scale-test.html | Browser-tab favicon at 16–256 px.                                |
|                         |                                                                  |
|                         |                                                                  |

## 9 · FILES AT A GLANCE

```
brand/
├─ spec/brand.json                # the asset tree as data – SINGLE SOUR
├─ palette/colors.json           # colour canon (colors.css is GENERATE
├─ logos/rtam-wordmark-*.svg      # 6 Latin Foundation wordmark variants
├─ logos/rtam-wordmark-devanagari-*.svg # 2 Devanagari Foundation wordmarks (p
├─ logos/rtam-temple-wordmark-*.svg # 3 temple wordmarks (latin, diacritic
├─ icons/rtam-rdot-icon-*.svg     # 8 R-monogram variants (5 open + 3 ci
├─ icons/rtam-devanagari-ri-icon-*.svg # 4 ॐ monogram variants
├─ icons/favicon.svg + favicon-dark.svg # 32 viewBox favicons (light + dark ta
├─ lockups/*.svg                 # 5 lockup compositions
├─ iconography/reference/        # sanctum murti reference (design inte
├─ previews/index.html           # master gallery (single-sourced from
├─ previews/{wordmark,monogram,devanagari-monogram,lockups}-specimen.html
├─ previews/mockups/*.html       # application mockups
├─ guidelines/{brand-book,usage-rules}.md
├─ tools/brandlib.py + generate.py + outline.py + parity.py + palette_sync.py
|                                # generator: brand.json → source SVGs
├─ tools/render_*.py             # SVG→PNG, HTML→PNG/PDF, MD→PDF
├─ dist/outlined/*.svg           # COMMITTED distribution masters – the
|                                # (font-free <path> geometry; parity.p
└─ exports/{png,pdf,mockups,platform}/ # rendered outputs
```

**Consuming the kit:** embed from `brand/dist/outlined/` — those masters carry no font dependency, so they render identically in `<img>` tags, Office documents, print RIPs, and design tools. The live-text SVGs under `logos/ icons/ lockups/` are the *editable sources*, faithful only where the brand fonts are installed.

**Editing the kit:** change `brand/spec/brand.json`, then run `brand/tools/build.sh --write`. Hand-editing the SVGs is no longer the workflow — the generator regenerates every source SVG and outlined master from the spec, and the parity gate proves fidelity. This is what keeps the bindu (and every other coordinate) identical across the whole tree.

## V2 · THE ṚTĀMBHAREŚVARA SYSTEM (2026-07-12)

Everything above remains true of the wordmark; this chapter records the convergence that followed — the icon, its ladder, and the substance palette — all founder-locked. Where an

earlier section contradicts this chapter (grounds, night colour, favicon), **this chapter wins**; legacy assets keep their files until migration completes.

## V2.1 THE ICON — THE ṚTA-CHAKRA

The icon is the temple's own murti seen from above: a corolla of **twelve lotus petals** (the E3 *mukta* silhouette — narrow attachment, full body) rising from the jaladhari, the water's calm, and a stone rim pierced by **twelve Āditya windows aligned with the petal tips**, the **Shivalinga gold at the hub**. Every radius derives from `iconography/geometry/grid.json` ; the mark is generated from `spec/brand.json` (assets `ṛta-chakra` , `anahata-mark` , `bindu-mark` ) — never drawn by hand.

## V2.2 THE SANCTITY LADDER — REDUCTION AS THEOLOGY

One geometry, three rungs, the same gold centre at every scale:

| RUNG              | MARK               | MEANING                           | USE                                 |
|-------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>ṛta-chakra</b> | full icon          | the Lord bearing the cosmic order | ≥ 48 px; brand surfaces             |
| <b>anāhata</b>    | bare corolla       | the Lord in the heart             | community/devotee surfaces, avatars |
| <b>bindu</b>      | circled gold point | the Lord alone                    | < 48 px, favicon, seal-dot          |

**The ladder rule:** below 48 px the chakra is never shrunk — it steps down a rung. The favicon *is* the bindu. The dot under the R of RTAM and the hub of the chakra are the same point.

## V2.3 THE SUBSTANCE PALETTE

Colours are the ritual substances that touch the Lord — never decoration (canon: `palette/colors.json` v0.2.0):

| SUBSTANCE | TOKEN                                 | HEX                           | ROLE                                                                                                          |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mahākāla  | mahakala                              | #141414                       | the linga stone, the sanctum dark<br>— the brand ground                                                       |
| Dīpa      | gold                                  | #C8A15A                       | the lamp flame — god-points,<br>display on black, <b>foil in print</b> ;<br>decorative-only on light (2.03:1) |
| Bhasma    | bhasma /<br>stoneGray /<br>bhasmaDeep | #C9C2B6<br>#B8B1A4<br>#8F887C | vibhūti ash — body text (10.42<br>AAA) and captions (5.25 AA) on<br>mahakala                                  |
| Kansya    | bronze                                | #9B6A2F                       | bell-metal — large<br>sizes/ornament on mahakala only<br>(3.94)                                               |
| Tāmra     | tamraCopper                           | #7A5423                       | abhisheka copper — links/CTAs<br>on light (5.65 on chandra;<br>Pantone 1405C)                                 |
| Chandra   | chandra                               | #EDEBE6                       | the moon-paper — the reading<br>ground                                                                        |

**Retired from brand surfaces:** deepIndigo, jala teal, warmIvory as a ground, sandstone as a panel. Ceremonial accents (kumkum #C41E3A on light, flame-ember #D98E32 on dark) appear on festival surfaces only — never UI, never body text.

## V2.4 THE REGISTERS

| REGISTER                      | GROUND   | TYPE                                        | WHEN                                                 |
|-------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Garbhagriha</b><br>(leads) | mahakala | gold display · bhasma body                  | all dark surfaces, city print,<br>video              |
| <b>Bhasma-day</b>             | chandra  | charcoal ink · tāmra<br>accents · gold once | website body, documents                              |
| <b>Kanaka</b>                 | mahakala | all-gold mark · ash text                    | festivals, invitations — foil on<br>matte soft-touch |
|                               |          |                                             |                                                      |

## V2.5 ENTITIES AND SCRIPTS

Two entities, two scripts, one icon. The Foundation speaks as **RTAM Foundation** / ऋतम् प्रतिष्ठान; the temple as **R̥tambhareśvara Mandir** / ऋतम्भरेश्वर मंदिर. Devanagari leads on city surfaces; English leads on web — same grid either way, Devanagari at least 2× its support line. Every voice ships in light and garbhagriha forms ( \*-garbhagriha.svg ). The murti's front elevation (24 tattvas) is reserved for a future consecrated Mandir mark.

## V2.6 PRINT FINISH

Ceremonial print is **matte soft-touch mahakala with hot-stamp gold foil** — gloss against matte. Flex/outdoor prints gold as ink; reading stationery is uncoated chandra stock with gold used once per page.

**Resolved for stationery (2026-08-26):** the chandra ground is achieved by the PAPER, never printed — BILT Royal Executive Bond "Corona Cream" 100 gsm everyday, Conqueror Cream Wove 100 gsm for formal runs. The letterhead's one gold is the chakra's hub (= the bindu, v2.2 — see usage-rules §7). The stationery system itself lives in brand/stationery/ (letterhead press/mono + DOCX, दान-रसीद NCR book, Ø 50 mm full-chakra seal + 75×38 bilingual address stamp, ST-8 label sheet), with its own build and checks.

*The work continues steadily, in keeping with the order it intends to serve.*

— ऋतस्य पन्थाम्